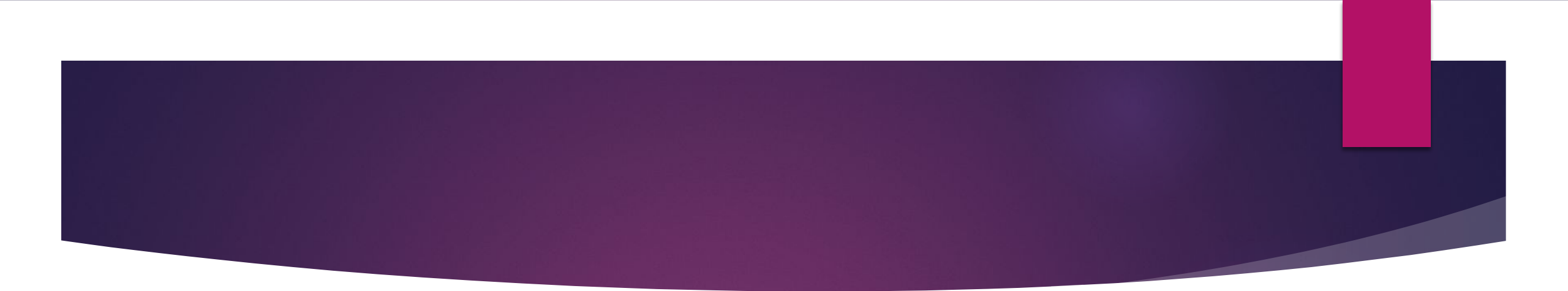


Managing Information Resources

-NILAM SANGROULA

Definition of IRM

- ▶ Information Resource Management (IRM) is a technique of managing information as a shared organizational resource. IRM includes
 - (1) identification of information sources,
 - (2) type and value of the information they provide, and
 - (3) ways of classification, valuation, processing, and storage of that information.
- ▶ Information Resource Management (IRM) is a broad term in IT that refers to the management of records or information or data sets as a resource. This can relate to either business or government goals and objectives. Information resource management involves identifying data as an asset, categorizing it and providing various types of active management.
- ▶ Experts describe IRM as the process of managing the life cycle of data sets, from their creation to their use in IT architectures, and on to archiving and eventual destruction of non-permanent data. The term IRM can refer to either software resources, physical supplies and materials, or personnel involved in managing information at any stage of use

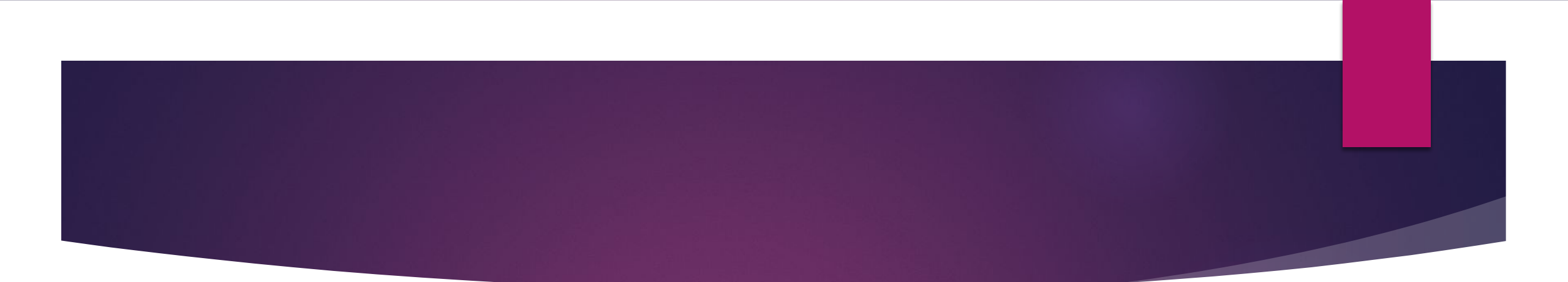
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- ▶ According to Bergeron (1996), IRM is grounded in the following assumptions:
 - ▶ recognition of information as a resource;
 - ▶ an integrative management perspective;
 - ▶ management of the information life cycle;
 - ▶ a link with strategic planning.

Effective IRM Management

- ▶ Nick Willard of ASLIB's IRM Network (now the IRM SIG) has developed a model highlighting the five key activities for their effective IRM management:
 - ▶ Identification: What information is there? How is it identified and coded?
 - ▶ Ownership: Who is responsible for different information entities and co-ordination?
 - ▶ Cost and Value: A basic model for making judgements on purchase and use
 - ▶ Development: Increasing its value (see '10 ways to add value to your business') or stimulating demand.
 - ▶ Exploitation: Proactive maximization of value for money

Implementing Information Resource Management (IRM)

- ▶ Implementing Information Resource Management (IRM) requires a long term strategy. In implementing IRM strategy senior managers must not be concerned simply with quick results to information problems or technical fixes to their operational problems. IRM requires a long term view of organizational change and adjustment.
- ▶ Information Resource Management (IRM) must be implemented incrementally and not all at once. IRM requires attention to many areas of responsibility. In implementing IRM it is unlikely that an organization will seek to address and resolve issues in all areas at one time. Instead, the IRM plan should provide a path by which the areas of greatest concern are addressed in a phased manner.

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- ▶ Implementing Information Resource Management (IRM) requires only attention to and planning for administrative changes that may be needed. Inevitably, even in phase 1 the IRM strategy will require attention to realigning organizational subunits or reassigning management and technical staff. In other cases, IRM may require changes in procurement policies for IT or interpretations of rules and procedures. In still other instances, IRM may require that the organization create new positions, such as an IRM Director or IR planner. In all these cases, the successful implementation of IRM plans will need to anticipate such policy, regulatory, and administrative changes.
 - ▶ Implementation of IRM requires consistency in executive leadership. A major ingredient for successful IRM implementation is consistency and stability in the organization's executive leadership. Since the implementation of IRM can require from three to five years, and therefore necessitate a strong consensus on the part of the senior managers of the organization that IRM is worth pursuing, frequent changes in this leadership group will lead to inconsistency in the pursuit of IRM objectives and plans.

Barriers to IRM

- ▶ Ineffective information resource management often results in massive cost overruns, long schedule delays, and systems that do not perform as intended. Some of the causes to this ineffectiveness are:
 - ▶ Lack of well-defined IRM concepts
 - ▶ Lack of IRM training or awareness
 - ▶ Lack of agreement on objectives
 - ▶ Lack of ability to attract and retain skilled people

Benefits of Information Resource Management (IRM)

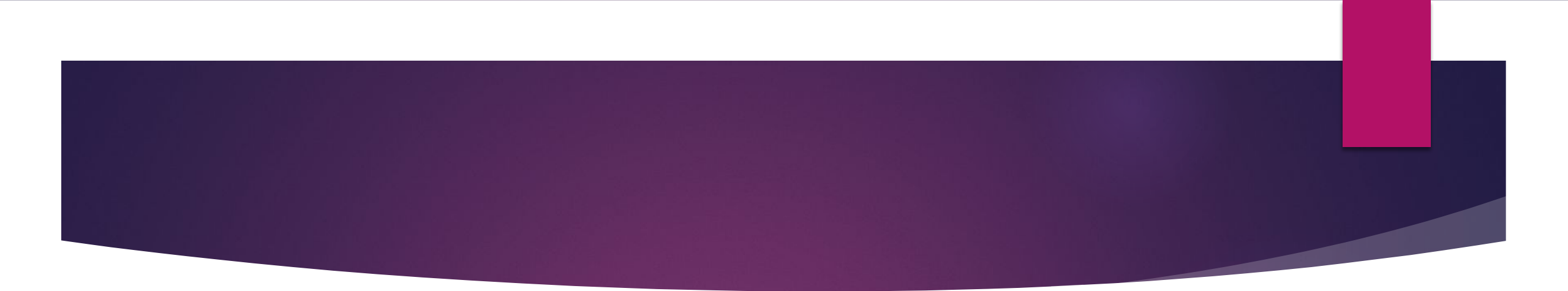
- ▶ IRM has Numerous Benefits
 - ▶ IRM assists in development of systems that are targeted to support strategic and operational objectives;
 - ▶ In IRM , there is increased integration of technologies, which improves the sharing of information across the organization and makes it easier to obtain information for changing decision making needs needs;
 - ▶ IRM Assist in identification and adoption of appropriate information technology standards, minimizing dependence on specific suppliers of hardware or software;
 - ▶ IRM helps in identification of opportunities to improve the relevance and adequacy of information provided and activities performed;
 - ▶ IRM offers a technological infrastructure that will support the strategic business plan;
 - ▶ IRM helps in minimization of duplicate, and possibly inconsistent, data and processing capabilities within the organization's portfolio of information systems;
 - ▶ There is prioritization of projects to be implemented and greater cost-justification of system development and maintenance activities.

Principles of managing information resources

- ▶ Information Accuracy
- ▶ Information Completeness
- ▶ Timeliness
- ▶ Relevance
- ▶ Accessibility
- ▶ Governance
- ▶ Risk Management
- ▶ Cost-Effectiveness
- ▶ Innovation
- ▶ Continuous Improvement

The Goals of Information Resource Management (IRM)

- ▶ The goals of IRM fall into seven major categories]:
 - ▶ Paperwork Reduction: The primary goal of the PR is to minimize the amount of paperwork required from individuals, small businesses, educational institutions, and government entities when interacting with constituent organisations. This includes reducing unnecessary reporting and recordkeeping requirements
 - ▶ Data Processing and Telecommunications: establishing policies for effective acquisition and utilization of computer and telecommunications resources. These included promoting the use of information processing technology and enforcing standards.
 - ▶ Statistics: developing long-range plans for improved performance of Federal statistical activities and the development and coordination of Government-wide statistical policies.
 - ▶ Records Management: correcting the deficiencies in existing records management practices and coordinating them with other IRM functions. A related objective was the development of standards for record retention for all sectors.

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- ▶ Information Sharing and Disclosure: managing decisions relative to the threat to privacy and confidentiality. Policy guidance on disclosure of information, confidentiality, and security of information would be set. To enhance general management practice, it recommended legislation to remove the inconsistencies.
 - ▶ Information Policy and Oversight: establishing a strong, central management function responsible for the development of uniform and consistent information policies. To insure success, the agencies were to be given adequate guidance in the conduct of their information management activities.
 - ▶ Organization Development and Administration: creating the steps necessary for the establishment and funding of the Office of Information and Regulatory Affairs.